

DSAT TRANSITIONS — 80 SOLUTIONS

Full answer key | Step-by-step reasoning | Trap alerts & key insights

SECTION A — EASY (Q1–Q16)

Q1. [Easy] Correct Answer: C) Thus,

REASONING: The first sentence states a fact (coral reefs support ~25% of marine species). The second sentence draws a logical consequence from that fact (their decline threatens all those organisms). The relationship is cause → effect.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "For example" introduces a specific illustration, but the second sentence is a logical consequence, not an example of the first.
- B) "Similarly" signals a parallel situation, but the second sentence is not a separate analogous case—it follows directly from the first.
- D) "Instead" signals replacement or an alternative, which doesn't fit; the second sentence doesn't replace the first idea.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "For example" is tempting because students may think the "web of organisms" illustrates the "one quarter" statistic, but the second sentence is a consequence of reef decline, not an example of biodiversity.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** When sentence 2 states what logically follows from sentence 1, choose a cause/effect transition (thus, therefore, consequently, as a result).

■ **FAST METHOD:** Ask "Does sentence 2 happen *because of* sentence 1?" If yes → cause/effect transition.

Q2. [Easy] Correct Answer: A) On the contrary,

REASONING: The first sentence presents a common assumption (bats can't see). The second sentence directly contradicts it (most bats *can* see). This is a direct refutation, requiring a contradiction transition.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "In addition" adds compatible information, but the second sentence refutes rather than supplements the first.
- C) "Subsequently" implies chronological sequence, which is irrelevant here.
- D) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the second sentence contradicts rather than exemplifies the claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** Students might pick "In addition" thinking the sentence just adds more information about bats. But the key signal is contradiction: "implies that bats cannot see" vs. "most bat species possess functional eyes."

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "On the contrary" is used when the second sentence *directly opposes* or *refutes* the claim in the first. Contrast transitions like "however" soften the opposition; "on the contrary" makes it absolute.

■ **FAST METHOD:** Look for a misconception in sentence 1 that sentence 2 corrects. Misconception → correction = "on the contrary."

Q3. [Easy] Correct Answer: B) For example,

REASONING: Sentence 2 states that merchants carried "more than just silk." Sentence 3 lists specific goods (spices, glassware, metals)—these are examples of the "more than just silk" claim.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession/contrast, but the third sentence supports rather than opposes the second.

- C) "By contrast" introduces an opposing idea, which doesn't fit—the examples illustrate rather than oppose the claim.
- D) "As a result" implies causation, but the listing of goods is not a consequence of the general claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "As a result" can tempt students who see the goods as outcomes of trade, but the logical function here is illustration, not consequence.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** When a general claim is followed by specific items that demonstrate it, the transition is "for example" or "for instance."

■ **FAST METHOD:** Does sentence 2 give specific items that fall under the general category in the sentence before it? → "For example."

Q4. [Easy] Correct Answer: D) Next,

REASONING: The passage describes sequential steps in a tea ceremony: first the host cleans and arranges utensils, then the host heats water and measures tea. The relationship is chronological sequence.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "However" signals contrast, but step 2 does not oppose step 1.
- B) "In other words" restates the same idea differently, but the second sentence describes a new step, not a restatement.
- C) "On the contrary" refutes the previous statement, which doesn't fit a sequential process.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** Students may overthink this and look for a logical relationship, but the passage explicitly describes an ordered process ("first...").

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** When a passage describes steps in a process and uses "first" or "initially," look for sequence transitions (next, then, subsequently, afterward).

■ **FAST METHOD:** See "first" in the sentence before the blank → the blank almost certainly needs a sequence word.

Q5. [Easy] Correct Answer: A) In comparison,

REASONING: The first sentence gives Mercury's orbital period (88 days, shortest). The second sentence gives Neptune's (165 years). The two planets are being compared on the same metric (orbital period), with contrasting values.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Therefore" implies Neptune's long orbit is caused by Mercury's short orbit, which is nonsensical.
- C) "Likewise" suggests Neptune's orbit is similar to Mercury's, but 165 years is the opposite extreme from 88 days.
- D) "In addition" simply adds information, but the passage is making a specific comparison between two extremes.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "Likewise" is the classic trap. Students see two planets and assume similarity, but the data points are opposite extremes.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "In comparison" and "by contrast" both work for contrasting data, but "in comparison" is preferred when two items are measured on the same scale with different values.

■ **FAST METHOD:** Same metric + different values = comparison transition.

Q6. [Easy] Correct Answer: C) Specifically,

REASONING: The second sentence says many species are found nowhere else. The third sentence gives a specific example (the Baikal seal) that narrows the general claim down to one particular instance.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" introduces an opposing idea, but the seal example supports rather than opposes the uniqueness claim.

- B) "Furthermore" adds a new, separate point, but the seal is not a new point—it's a specific instance of the "many species" claim.
- D) "Nevertheless" signals a concession, but there's no tension between the sentences.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "Furthermore" is tempting because the seal fact does add information. But the key distinction is that the seal fact **narrows** the general claim (many species → one specific species). That's specification, not addition.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Specifically" zooms in from a general statement to a particular instance. "Furthermore" adds a genuinely new, parallel point.

■ **FAST METHOD:** General claim → particular instance of that claim = "specifically" or "in particular."

Q7. [Easy] Correct Answer: B) However,

REASONING: The first sentence presents a common assumption (humps store water). The second sentence reveals the reality is different (humps are fat). This is a contrast between misconception and fact.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Similarly" suggests agreement, but the second sentence corrects the first.
- C) "Therefore" implies consequence, but the composition of humps is not a result of the assumption.
- D) "Next" implies sequence, which doesn't apply.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** This is a straightforward misconception-correction pattern. The trap is "Similarly," which students might choose if they focus on both sentences being "about humps" rather than on the logical relationship.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Misconception → factual correction = contrast transition.

■ **FAST METHOD:** "Many people assume X. [blank] Y is actually the case." → "However."

Q8. [Easy] Correct Answer: D) Therefore,

REASONING: Sentence 1 identifies a problem (raw cassava contains cyanide-releasing compounds). Sentence 2 describes a response to that problem (communities developed processing techniques). The second sentence follows logically from the first.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" introduces an opposing idea, but the processing techniques are a response to the danger, not a contrast.
- B) "For instance" introduces an example, but the processing techniques are a consequence, not an illustration of the danger.
- C) "In addition" adds a separate fact, but the soaking/fermentation is directly motivated by the danger.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "In addition" sounds reasonable because the processing methods are additional information about cassava. But the key is causation: **because** cassava is dangerous, communities developed these techniques.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Problem → response/solution = cause-effect transition.

■ **FAST METHOD:** Does the second sentence describe what people/organisms **do because of** what's described in the first? → cause/effect.

Q9. [Easy] Correct Answer: A) Similarly,

REASONING: Chomsky proposes that languages share a common grammatical structure. Pinker argues that language capacity is an innate biological trait. Both scholars make parallel claims about innate, universal aspects of language. The relationship is similarity.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "However" signals contrast, but Pinker's claim is compatible with and parallel to Chomsky's, not opposed.

- C) "Instead" signals replacement, but Pinker doesn't replace Chomsky's idea.
- D) "For example" introduces an illustration, but Pinker's claim is a parallel argument, not an example of Universal Grammar.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "For example" tempts students who see Pinker as illustrating the innate-language idea. But Pinker is making his own parallel argument, not exemplifying Chomsky's specific theory.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Two different scholars/sources making compatible, parallel claims = "similarly" or "likewise."

■ **FAST METHOD:** Scholar A says X. Scholar B says something in the same vein → "Similarly" or "Likewise."

Q10. [Easy] Correct Answer: C) In addition,

REASONING: The first sentence mentions stone pillars dating to 9500 BCE. The second sentence adds another discovery from the same site (animal carvings). Both are findings at Göbekli Tepe. The relationship is addition.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" introduces an opposing idea, but the carvings are not opposed to the pillars—they're supplementary findings.
- B) "Therefore" implies consequence, but the carvings are not a result of the pillars' existence.
- D) "However" signals contrast, which doesn't fit two complementary archaeological findings.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** None of the wrong answers are particularly tempting here—this is a straightforward addition pattern.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** When sentence 2 adds a new, separate finding from the same context, "in addition" or "furthermore" is appropriate.

■ **FAST METHOD:** Same site/source, new finding = addition transition.

Q11. [Easy] Correct Answer: B) As a result,

REASONING: Bees transfer pollen to flowers (cause). Plants are fertilized and produce fruit/seeds (effect). The relationship is direct cause → effect.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In comparison" introduces a comparison, but no two things are being compared.
- C) "For instance" introduces an example, but fertilization is not an example of pollen transfer—it's a consequence.
- D) "Nevertheless" signals concession/contrast, which doesn't apply.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** Students may choose "For instance" thinking fertilization is an example of what happens when bees visit flowers. But the relationship is causal: pollination **causes** fertilization.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Mechanism → outcome = cause/effect.

■ **FAST METHOD:** Action in sentence 1 directly produces the outcome in sentence 2 → "as a result."

Q12. [Easy] Correct Answer: D) Ultimately,

REASONING: The passage describes a multi-step analytical process (collecting samples → comparing to chronology). The blank introduces the final outcome of that process (the construction date). "Ultimately" signals the end result of a sequence.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By comparison" introduces a comparison between two things, but the passage culminates in a single finding.
- B) "In addition" adds a new point, but the date is the culmination, not an additional finding.
- C) "Similarly" signals a parallel, but there's no second analogous process.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "In addition" is the trap—students may see the date as just another piece of information. But the passage builds toward a conclusion: process → final result.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Multi-step process → final finding = "ultimately" or "finally." This pattern appears frequently on the DSAT with research/analysis passages.

■ **FAST METHOD:** A described process ends with a concluding finding → "Ultimately."

Q13. [Easy] Correct Answer: A) In doing so,

REASONING: The first sentence describes what students do (sketch objects from multiple angles). The second sentence describes what they gain through that activity (proportion and spatial awareness). "In doing so" means "by performing that activity."

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "By contrast" introduces opposition, but the second sentence builds on the first.
- C) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the gained skills are a result of the practice, not an example of it.
- D) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't apply.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** Students might pick "For example" thinking the skills are examples of outcomes. But "in doing so" captures the process → benefit relationship more precisely.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "In doing so" connects an activity to its direct benefit or result. It implies "by performing the action just described."

■ **FAST METHOD:** Activity described → benefit gained from that activity = "In doing so."

Q14. [Easy] Correct Answer: D) Still,

REASONING: Scientists assumed deep trenches were lifeless (expectation). Recent expeditions found thriving communities there (surprise/contrary evidence). The blank needs a concession transition that acknowledges the previous assumption but introduces contradictory evidence.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Therefore" implies consequence, but the expeditions' findings contradict rather than follow from the assumption.
- B) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the findings oppose the assumption.
- C) "In addition" adds compatible information, but the findings challenge the assumption.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "In addition" is the main trap. The findings are additional information, but they contradict the expectation—that's concession, not mere addition.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Still" and "nonetheless" work when evidence or reality contradicts a prior assumption or expectation. Look for assumption → surprising contrary reality.

■ **FAST METHOD:** "Scientists assumed X. [blank] evidence shows not-X." → concession transition.

Q15. [Easy] Correct Answer: B) In other words,

REASONING: The first sentence defines a calorie in nutritional terms (unit of energy from food). The second sentence restates the same concept using a technical physics definition (heat needed to raise water temperature). The second sentence is a reformulation.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the second sentence doesn't oppose the first.
- C) "By contrast" introduces an opposing idea, but both sentences define the same concept.
- D) "Furthermore" adds new information, but the second sentence restates rather than supplements.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "Furthermore" is tempting because the physics definition seems like additional information. But it's the same definition restated more technically—a reformulation, not an addition.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "In other words" signals a restatement or clarification of the same idea in different terms.

■ FAST METHOD: Same idea, different phrasing = "in other words" or "that is."

Q16. [Easy] Correct Answer: D) Nevertheless,

REASONING: The first sentence describes massive destruction (millions of hectares burned, animals displaced). The second sentence shows that conservation efforts continued despite this devastation. This is a concession pattern: severe setback → ongoing effort despite it.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Therefore" implies the conservation efforts are a logical result of the fires, but the passage emphasizes persistence despite adversity, not consequence.
- B) "For example" introduces an illustration, which doesn't fit.
- C) "Similarly" signals a parallel, but the second sentence isn't analogous—it's about resilience in the face of the disaster.

■ TRAP ALERT: "Therefore" is the biggest trap. Students might reason: fires destroyed habitat → therefore, conservationists work to restore it. But the passage's tone emphasizes persistence despite catastrophe, not logical consequence.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Destruction/obstacle → ongoing effort despite it = concession (nevertheless, nonetheless, still, even so).

■ FAST METHOD: Bad outcome + continued positive action = concession transition.

SECTION B — MEDIUM (Q17–Q48)

Q17. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) By contrast,

REASONING: Acoustic guitars amplify sound through a hollow body (mechanical resonance). Electric guitars use magnetic pickups and electronic amplification. These are fundamentally different mechanisms for the same purpose, requiring a contrast transition.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Likewise" signals similarity, but the mechanisms are different.
- C) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the passage highlights a difference in method.
- D) "Ultimately" signals a final conclusion, which doesn't fit a comparison of two types.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Same goal, different methods = contrast.

Q18. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) Furthermore,

REASONING: The first sentence states Vega's main finding (trade networks were more extensive than thought). The second sentence adds supporting evidence (ceramic styles spread 800 km). The ceramic evidence strengthens and adds to the main claim.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the ceramic analysis supports rather than undermines the finding.
- B) "By contrast" introduces opposition, which doesn't fit.
- D) "Instead" signals replacement, which doesn't apply.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Main claim → additional supporting evidence = "furthermore" or "moreover."

Q19. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Consequently,

REASONING: Less oxygen at high altitude (cause) → mountaineers experience altitude sickness (effect). Direct cause and effect.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Similarly" implies a parallel; no second analogous situation is presented.
- C) "In comparison" is for comparing two things on the same metric.
- D) "Granted" makes a concession, which doesn't fit a cause → effect relationship.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Environmental condition → physiological consequence = cause/effect.

Q20. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) For instance,

REASONING: The second sentence says such knowledge is a valuable complement to Western science (general claim). The third sentence gives a specific case (Aboriginal burning practices studied by fire ecologists). This is a general claim followed by a specific example.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "However" signals contrast, but the example supports the claim.
- B) "In other words" restates the same idea, but the Aboriginal example is a new, specific case.
- C) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't fit.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** General assertion about value → specific case demonstrating that value = "for instance."

Q21. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) Likewise,

REASONING: Hadid uses sweeping curves and fluid geometries. Calatrava also favors organic, curvilinear forms. Both architects share a similar design philosophy. The relationship is parallel similarity.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals difference, but the two architects are described as sharing a similar approach.
- C) "Therefore" implies Calatrava's style results from Hadid's, which is not stated.
- D) "Next" implies sequence, which doesn't apply.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Architect A does X. Architect B also does X. → "Likewise" or "Similarly."

Q22. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Of course,

REASONING: The passage notes that millions of years of material are "missing" between rock layers. The "of course" sentence acknowledges an obvious point that the reader might raise: time didn't actually stop. This is an acknowledgment of something self-evident before continuing the explanation.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "In addition" adds a new separate point, but the sentence clarifies the obvious.
- C) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the sentence is an acknowledgment.
- D) "Meanwhile" signals simultaneous events, which doesn't fit.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** This is a tricky "Of course" pattern. The sentence preemptively addresses a reader's objection (that time didn't stop) before explaining what actually happened (erosion).

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Of course" acknowledges something obviously true that might be misunderstood from the prior statement. It functions as a preemptive clarification.

Q23. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) Instead,

REASONING: Kepler concluded orbits are "not circular." The next sentence tells us what they are instead: elliptical. The relationship is replacement—one idea replaces another.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the elliptical model replaces the circular model.
- B) "In addition" adds to the circular idea, but elliptical orbits replace it.
- D) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't capture the replacement.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Not X → Instead, Y." When the passage rejects one idea and substitutes another, "instead" is the right transition.

Q24. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) Specifically,

REASONING: The first sentence makes a general claim (extraordinary concentration of endemic species). The blank sentence narrows to a specific metric (260+ endemic amphibian species). This is general → specific.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "However" signals contrast, but the amphibian data supports the biodiversity claim.
- B) "As a result" implies causation, which doesn't fit.
- C) "In comparison" requires a second thing being compared.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** General biodiversity claim → specific numeric data supporting it = "specifically."

Q25. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Accordingly,

REASONING: The vaccine showed strong results (>90% antibody response). The company accelerated its approval timeline. The company's action follows logically from the positive data—it's a response to evidence.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Nevertheless" implies the acceleration happened despite something, but the results supported acceleration.
- C) "For instance" introduces an example, but the acceleration is a consequence, not an illustration.
- D) "By contrast" signals opposition, which doesn't fit.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Positive data → organizational decision based on data = cause/effect ("accordingly," "consequently," "therefore").

Q26. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) On the other hand,

REASONING: The first sentence presents one side (organic = more sustainable). The second sentence presents a counterpoint (organic can require more land → deforestation). This is a two-sided contrast.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the second sentence challenges the first.
- C) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the second sentence raises a concern that complicates the belief.
- D) "As a result" implies the land requirement results from the belief, which is incorrect.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Belief/assumption → complicating evidence = contrast transition.

Q27. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) Moreover,

REASONING: The first sentence states the ice sheet's massive volume. The second sentence adds a consequential detail: it holds 70% of all freshwater. Both facts emphasize the ice sheet's significance, and the second strengthens the first.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "However" signals contrast, but the second sentence amplifies, not opposes.
- B) "Instead" signals replacement, which doesn't apply.
- D) "Next" signals sequence, which doesn't fit.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Moreover" adds information that strengthens or amplifies the prior point. It's "addition with emphasis."

Q28. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) In particular,

REASONING: The first sentence says Renaissance painters developed "numerous techniques." The second sentence zooms in on one specific technique (linear perspective). This is general → specific/particular.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "On the contrary" refutes the prior sentence, but the example supports it.
- C) "Therefore" implies causation, which doesn't fit.
- D) "Instead" signals replacement, which doesn't apply.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Numerous techniques" → one specific technique = "in particular."

Q29. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) Subsequently,

REASONING: First, Fujimura conducted a visual survey. Then her team used ground-penetrating radar. This is a chronological sequence of investigative steps.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "For example" would mean radar is an example of visual survey, which doesn't make sense—it's a different method used afterward.
 - B) "However" signals contrast, but the radar step complements rather than opposes the visual survey.
 - C) "In other words" signals restatement, but radar scanning is a different step, not a rephrasing.
- KEY INSIGHT: Step 1 → Step 2 in a process = sequence transition ("subsequently," "next," "then").
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Q30. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) Nonetheless,

REASONING: Harsh conditions (wind, sparse soil, salt spray) seem inhospitable (expectation of no plant life). The reality is 70+ plant species exist there (surprising contrary evidence). This is a concession pattern.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Therefore" implies the plants are a consequence of the harsh conditions, which is backward.
 - C) "Similarly" signals a parallel, which doesn't fit a surprise outcome.
 - D) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the plant diversity contradicts the expectation set up by "inhospitable."
- TRAP ALERT: "In addition" is tempting because the plants are additional information. But the passage sets up an expectation (seems inhospitable) and then defies it (70+ species anyway). That's concession.
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Q31. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) In reality,

REASONING: The first sentence presents a tempting but incorrect assumption (both serve the same purpose). The second sentence corrects that assumption by revealing the reality (Yoshimoto focuses equally on grief/recovery). "In reality" signals the correction of a misconception.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Furthermore" adds compatible info, but the second sentence corrects rather than supplements.
 - B) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the second sentence reveals a difference.
 - D) "For instance" introduces an example, but the second sentence is a correction.
- KEY INSIGHT: "It is tempting to think X. [blank] Y is actually the case." → "In reality" or "however."
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Q32. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Thus,

REASONING: The axolotl has remarkable regeneration abilities (cause/reason). It has become a model organism in research (consequence). The species' unique ability is the reason researchers study it.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "By contrast" signals opposition, which doesn't fit.
 - C) "Regardless" dismisses something, which doesn't apply.
 - D) "Meanwhile" signals simultaneous events, but the research is a result of the ability, not a simultaneous occurrence.
- KEY INSIGHT: Unique biological trait → scientific interest = cause/effect.
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Q33. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) By comparison,

REASONING: Sentence 1 describes Roman aqueducts (gravity-fed, precise gradients). Sentence 2 describes modern systems (electric pumps, pressurized). The passage compares ancient vs. modern on the same topic (water transport technology).

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Furthermore" adds info, but the modern system is being contrasted, not added.
- B) "In other words" restates, but the modern system is a different thing, not a restatement.
- C) "As a result" implies modern systems resulted from Roman ones, which oversimplifies.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Ancient method → modern method = comparison/contrast.

Q34. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) To that end,

REASONING: Marchetti had a specific research goal (determine if shipping noise affects whale feeding). The next sentence describes the methods she used to achieve that goal (deployed recorders, tracked whales). "To that end" means "in order to achieve that goal."

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, which doesn't fit.
- C) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't apply.
- D) "Likewise" signals a parallel, but the method serves the goal—it's not a parallel situation.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Research question → methodology to answer it = purpose transition ("to that end").

Q35. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Meanwhile,

REASONING: Two separate teams in two different locations (Peru and Mexico) were working during the same excavation season. "Meanwhile" signals simultaneous events happening in different places.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Therefore" implies the Mexican discovery resulted from the Peruvian one, but they are independent projects.
- C) "For example" implies the Mexican site is an example of the Peruvian discovery, but it is a separate, parallel finding.
- D) "In other words" implies the Mexican discovery restates the Peruvian one, but they are distinct discoveries.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Two concurrent, independent projects in different locations during the same time period = "meanwhile."

Q36. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) For example,

REASONING: The first sentence makes a general claim (the immune system uses many specialized cells). The second sentence gives specific examples (macrophages, T cells) illustrating that claim.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't fit supportive examples.
- B) "In comparison" requires comparing two things on the same metric, which isn't happening.
- D) "As a result" implies the specific cells are a consequence of the general claim.

■ KEY INSIGHT: General claim about "many types" → specific types listed = "for example."

Q37. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) However,

REASONING: Critics praised the visual style (positive). Several reviewers noted plot problems (negative). The transition shifts from praise to criticism.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the second sentence introduces criticism after praise.
- C) "Therefore" implies the plot issues follow logically from the visual style being good.
- D) "In addition" adds compatible info, but plot criticism opposes the initial praise.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Positive assessment → negative criticism = contrast ("however," "but").

Q38. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) In addition,

REASONING: Carbon sink function (point 1). Habitat for caribou (point 2). These are two separate, important roles that boreal forests serve. Point 2 supplements point 1.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" introduces opposition, but the habitat role doesn't oppose the carbon sink role.
- B) "Instead" replaces one point with another.
- C) "Therefore" implies the habitat role results from the carbon-absorbing role.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Two independent beneficial functions of the same subject = addition.

Q39. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Conversely,

REASONING: Northern Hemisphere: winds curve right. Southern Hemisphere: winds curve left. The sentence explicitly mentions "mirror-image" patterns—the same phenomenon operating in the opposite direction.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Similarly" signals sameness, but left vs. right is an explicit reversal.
- C) "In addition" simply adds; this isn't a new separate fact but a mirror pattern.
- D) "Therefore" implies causation, which doesn't fit.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "Similarly" is the biggest trap. The Coriolis effect is the same phenomenon in both hemispheres, so students might think the relationship is similarity. But the *direction* is reversed (right vs. left), making it a "conversely" pattern.

Q40. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) Therefore,

REASONING: Carbon is exposed to oxygen when peatlands are drained (condition). The carbon oxidizes and releases CO₂ (consequence). Direct chemical cause → effect.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, but oxidation follows from exposure.
- B) "For instance" introduces an example, but oxidation is a consequence, not an illustration.
- D) "Similarly" signals a parallel, but the sentence describes what happens next, not an analogous case.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Chemical/physical condition → chemical/physical consequence = "therefore."

Q41. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) Indeed,

REASONING: The previous sentence states the capabilities are "not merely theoretical abstractions." The next sentence provides concrete evidence confirming this (incorporated into the UN HDI). "Indeed" emphasizes and affirms the preceding claim.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, but the UN incorporation confirms rather than opposes the claim.
- C) "Nonetheless" signals concession, which doesn't fit.
- D) "Instead" signals replacement, which doesn't apply.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Claim that something is not just abstract → concrete proof = "indeed" (emphasis/confirmation).

Q42. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) As a result,

REASONING: Cortisol impairs memory formation (established finding). Chronically stressed people report memory difficulties (observed consequence). The reported difficulties are a real-world manifestation of the biological mechanism.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the difficulties are consistent with the impairment, not surprising.
- B) "By contrast" signals opposition, which doesn't fit.
- C) "In comparison" requires two things being compared.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Biological mechanism → observable human consequence = "as a result."

Q43. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Still,

REASONING: Advances showed whales are mammals (established scientific correction). Some reference works continued categorizing them as fish (surprising persistence of the old error). Despite the scientific evidence, the outdated classification persisted.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Therefore" implies the continued miscategorization was a logical result of the correction, which is contradictory.
- C) "Specifically" narrows a general point, but the continued error is a surprising contrast.
- D) "In other words" restates, but the continued miscategorization is a different, surprising fact.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Scientific correction established → old error persisted anyway = concession ("still," "nonetheless").

Q44. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) Ultimately,

REASONING: The passage describes a sequence: eruption → ash in stratosphere → particles circled globe → reduced temperatures. The final sentence provides the concluding assessment: the eruption is considered one of the most influential volcanic events. This is a summary/conclusion.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "For instance" introduces an example, but the conclusion is a final assessment, not an illustration.
- B) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- D) "In addition" adds a new point, but the sentence concludes and summarizes the significance.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Sequence of events/effects → final evaluative assessment = "ultimately."

Q45. [Medium] Correct Answer: B) In contrast,

REASONING: Inkjet printers use liquid ink and droplets. Laser printers use powdered toner and heated rollers. These are different mechanisms for printing, requiring a contrast transition.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" adds info, but the passage highlights different mechanisms.
- C) "Therefore" implies laser printing results from inkjet printing.
- D) "Specifically" narrows a general point, but laser printing is an alternative, not a subtype.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Method A described → Method B works differently = "in contrast" or "by contrast."

Q46. [Medium] Correct Answer: A) Similarly,

REASONING: Al-Rashid found code-switching among multilingual children in Dubai. Mendes observed "the same pattern" among bilingual adolescents in Uruguay. The passage explicitly notes the same pattern appearing in a different context.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "However" signals contrast, but the findings are parallel.
- C) "Instead" signals replacement.
- D) "As a result" implies Mendes's finding resulted from Al-Rashid's.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Researcher A finds X. Researcher B finds the same thing in a different context. → "Similarly."

Q47. [Medium] Correct Answer: D) Specifically,

REASONING: The first sentence says the basin comprises "a mosaic of distinct habitat types" (general). The second sentence lists three specific habitat types (várzea, igapó, terra firme). This is general → specific.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" adds a new separate point, but the habitat types are the specific details of the "mosaic."
- B) "Therefore" implies the specific habitats are a consequence of the general description.
- C) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't fit.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Mosaic of distinct types" → listing those specific types = "specifically."

Q48. [Medium] Correct Answer: C) In doing so,

REASONING: Chen converted neglected lots into pocket parks (the action). The result was reduced flooding and increased walkability (the outcomes of that action). "In doing so" connects the action to its achieved outcomes.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- B) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the outcomes are positive results, not surprising ones.
- D) "For instance" introduces an example, but the outcomes are results of the action, not illustrations.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Specific intervention described → outcomes achieved through that intervention = "in doing so."

SECTION C — HARD (Q49–Q80)

Q49. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Beyond its thematic boldness,

REASONING: The first sentence discusses Clifton's collection and its thematic daring (writing about everyday Black life when that was considered too modest). The second sentence adds a *further* dimension—that her work also participated in a centuries-long literary tradition. "Beyond its thematic boldness" means "in addition to the thematic point already discussed, there was something more."

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In spite of this critical attention" implies the tradition element exists despite critical attention, but the passage doesn't set up that tension.
- B) "As a consequence of her stylistic restraint" implies the tradition-extending is caused by restraint, but the passage describes an additional dimension, not a causal chain.
- C) "Ultimately limited by its domestic scope" contradicts the tone—the passage is celebrating, not limiting, Clifton's work.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** Option C is the most dangerous trap—it seems to echo "too modest for serious literary treatment," but the passage is refuting that dismissiveness, not endorsing it.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Sentence-level transitions require reading the whole phrase, not just the first word. The correct answer must both fit the logical relationship AND be factually consistent with the passage.

Q50. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) Of course,

REASONING: The passage explains amber's remarkable preservation abilities. The blank sentence acknowledges an obvious limitation (amber doesn't preserve soft tissues or DNA equally well). "Of course" signals: "this is an obvious caveat that anyone would expect."

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" would suggest the limitation is simply added info, but it acknowledges a well-known caveat.
- C) "Therefore" implies the limitation is a consequence of good preservation, which is counterintuitive.
- D) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the sentence is a qualification.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Of course" is used to preemptively acknowledge an obvious caveat or limitation before continuing with the main argument.

Q51. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) Nevertheless,

REASONING: Nwosu's evidence comes only from short-term studies (a limitation). Despite this limitation, she still maintains that microfinance is critical. The transition signals persistence of the conclusion despite acknowledged weakness.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the final sentence is a conclusion, not an example.
- B) "As a result" implies the conclusion follows from the limitation, but she maintains her position despite it.
- D) "In comparison" requires two things being compared.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Acknowledged limitation → maintained conclusion despite it = concession ("nevertheless").

Q52. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) Consequently,

REASONING: Loss of milkweed reduced reproductive success (problem). Conservation organizations launched planting campaigns (response to that problem). The campaigns are a consequence of the decline.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "By contrast" signals opposition between two things.
- C) "Similarly" signals a parallel situation.
- D) "In addition" adds a separate point, but the campaigns are a direct response to the decline.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Ecological problem → conservation response = cause/effect.

Q53. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) In other words,

REASONING: Sentences 2-3 describe the Doppler effect through a concrete example (ambulance siren). The blank sentence restates the same phenomenon in technical terms (wave compression and stretching). It's a reformulation of the preceding example.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- B) "Nevertheless" signals concession.
- C) "In addition" adds new information, but the blank sentence explains the mechanism behind the example already given.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Concrete example → technical explanation of the same phenomenon = "in other words."

Q54. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) By contrast,

REASONING: West side of South Island: 6,000+ mm precipitation, dense podocarp forest. East side: <500 mm, drought-adapted grasslands. Same island, opposite conditions.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Furthermore" adds compatible info, but the passage highlights dramatic differences.
- C) "As a result" implies the grasslands result from the rainforests.
- D) "Specifically" narrows a general point, but the grasslands are a contrasting ecosystem, not a subset.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Same geographic entity, opposite conditions = "by contrast."

Q55. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Indeed,

REASONING: The first sentence says Tawada produces *separate* bodies of work in each language rather than translating. The second sentence affirms and intensifies this—Tawada herself states that certain stories can only exist in the language in which they were conceived. "Indeed" confirms and strengthens.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Granted" makes a concession to a counterargument, but the second sentence reinforces rather than concedes.
- B) "In addition" adds a new point, but the second sentence deepens the same point.
- C) "By contrast" signals opposition, which doesn't fit.

■ KEY INSIGHT: Claim → author's own statement confirming and intensifying that claim = "indeed."

Q56. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) For this reason,

REASONING: The mantle plume generates high volumes of magma (cause). Iceland has more eruptions and thicker crust (effect). The geological feature explains the observed phenomena.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Similarly" signals a parallel, but the second sentence is a consequence.

- B) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the eruptions are expected given the plume.
 - D) "In comparison" requires a second entity being compared.
- KEY INSIGHT: Geological mechanism → observable geological features = "for this reason."
-

Q57. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Specifically,

REASONING: The collection includes 900+ manuscripts spanning many genres (general). The blank sentence lists specific types of manuscripts (biblical copies, religious writings, community rules, legal documents). General → specific examples within the collection.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, which doesn't fit.
 - B) "As a result" implies the manuscript types result from the find being important.
 - C) "Instead" signals replacement, which doesn't apply.
- KEY INSIGHT: "Wide range of genres" → enumeration of those genres = "specifically."
-

Q58. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) In particular,

REASONING: Petersson cautioned that correlation ≠ causation (general methodological concern). The blank sentence narrows to a specific concern: confounding variables (preexisting ability, socioeconomic background, parental involvement). This zooms in on a particular aspect of the general caution.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "By contrast" signals opposition, but the confounding variables are a specific articulation of the caution, not an opposing idea.
 - C) "Furthermore" adds a new separate point, but the confounding variables are a specific dimension of the same concern.
 - D) "Similarly" signals a parallel, which doesn't fit.
- KEY INSIGHT: General caution → specific articulation of that caution = "in particular."
-

Q59. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) To that end,

REASONING: Herrera aimed to quantify lionfish displacement rates (research goal). He established survey stations and monitored populations (methodology to achieve that goal). "To that end" means "in service of that objective."

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "By contrast" signals opposition.
 - C) "In addition" adds a new point, but the methodology directly serves the stated goal.
 - D) "Nevertheless" signals concession.
- KEY INSIGHT: Research goal → methods designed to achieve it = "to that end."
-

Q60. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) However,

REASONING: Oduya hypothesized public recognition > private bonuses for satisfaction. Her data showed no significant difference. The result contradicted her hypothesis.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the data contradicts the hypothesis.
- B) "For instance" introduces an example, but the data is a contradicting result, not an illustration.

- D) "Therefore" implies the null result follows logically from the hypothesis, but it contradicts it.
- TRAP ALERT: "Therefore" is the biggest trap—students might think: hypothesis tested → data showed result, so "therefore." But the data *contradicted* the hypothesis, so contrast is needed.
-

Q61. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) Thus,

REASONING: Scholars could read Greek and used it to decode hieroglyphics (method). The stone became the foundation of hieroglyphic understanding (consequence). The method led to the foundational status.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition.
 - C) "Nevertheless" signals concession.
 - D) "Meanwhile" signals simultaneous events.
- KEY INSIGHT: Successful decipherment method → foundational status = "thus."
-

Q62. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Furthermore,

REASONING: Finding 1: fungal networks transfer nutrients between trees. Finding 2: networks also transmit chemical warning signals. These are two separate, important discoveries about the same network. The second adds to the first.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, but warning signals don't oppose nutrient transfer.
 - B) "In other words" restates, but warning signals are a new discovery, not a restatement.
 - C) "Nevertheless" signals concession.
- KEY INSIGHT: Discovery 1 about X → additional discovery about the same X = "furthermore."
-

Q63. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) On the contrary,

REASONING: Visitors assume artificial dyes or mineral deposits cause the color (misconception). The color is actually from a natural biochemical process (reality). Direct refutation of the assumption.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the sentence refutes the assumption.
 - C) "Therefore" implies the natural process results from the assumption.
 - D) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the sentences are in direct opposition.
- KEY INSIGHT: Assumption → direct refutation = "on the contrary."
-

Q64. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) Similarly,

REASONING: Mehra documented potlatch ceremonies as wealth redistribution mechanisms. Holmberg observed the jajmani system also functions as a framework for circulating resources. Both are institutionalized resource-redistribution systems, though different in form. The relationship is parallel.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Therefore" implies the jajmani system results from the potlatch.
 - B) "Nevertheless" signals concession.
 - D) "Instead" signals replacement, but the jajmani system is an additional parallel case, not a replacement.
- KEY INSIGHT: Two different cultures, same functional pattern = "similarly."

Q65. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) Ultimately,

REASONING: The passage describes a long process (decade of testing, many materials, lab vs. field challenges). The blank sentence introduces the final successful outcome (a composite filter that worked). "Ultimately" signals the conclusion of a lengthy process.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, but the composite filter is the culmination, not a contrasting case.
- C) "For instance" introduces an example of failed materials, but the blank sentence is the final success.
- D) "In addition" adds info, but the sentence is the resolution, not just another finding.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Long process with setbacks → final successful outcome = "ultimately."

Q66. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) In particular,

REASONING: General claim: the phenomenon has been demonstrated across many modalities and conditions. The blank sentence narrows to one specific, well-known demonstration (the invisible gorilla experiment). General → specific/particular.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- B) "As a result" implies the experiment is a consequence of the general demonstrations.
- C) "Nevertheless" signals concession.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Demonstrated across many conditions" → one specific iconic demonstration = "in particular."

Q67. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) Nonetheless,

REASONING: Two opposing positions are presented (critics: software can't evaluate; proponents: software catches errors well). The blank sentence describes a practical compromise (hybrid approach). Despite the disagreement, instructors found a middle path. This is a concession to the reality of both sides.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "In other words" restates, but the hybrid approach is a new resolution, not a restatement.
- C) "Similarly" signals a parallel.
- D) "Instead" signals replacement of one approach with another, but the hybrid combines both.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "Instead" is tempting because instructors chose a different approach. But they didn't abandon either position—they combined elements of both. That's compromise despite tension, which is concession.

Q68. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) As a consequence,

REASONING: Evaporation exceeds inflow → salts concentrate (general mechanism described). The Great Salt Lake experienced salinity increases because upstream diversion reduced inflow while evaporation continued (specific consequence of that mechanism). The sentence traces a direct causal chain from the described process to an observable outcome.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, but the Great Salt Lake's situation is consistent with the mechanism, not opposed to it.
- B) "For instance" introduces a representative example of a general claim, but the sentence emphasizes causation: "as decades of upstream water diversion have reduced inflow while persistent evaporation has continued to shrink the lake."

This causal language marks it as a consequence, not a mere illustration.

- D) "Similarly" signals a parallel situation, but the Great Salt Lake is an outcome of the described process, not a separate analogous case.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "For instance" is the biggest trap because the Great Salt Lake does illustrate the general mechanism. But the sentence's causal language ("as decades of... have reduced... while... has continued") traces a direct cause-and-effect chain, making "as a consequence" the more precise transition.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** When the sentence explains WHY and HOW the outcome occurred (not just that it occurred), the relationship is causal, not illustrative.

Q69. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) Meanwhile,

REASONING: Thornton's monograph focuses on diplomatic correspondence (one scholar's project). Matsuda's study analyzes commercial trade records during an overlapping period (a concurrent, separate scholarly project). These are simultaneous, parallel scholarly efforts.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Therefore" implies Matsuda's study resulted from Thornton's.
- C) "In other words" implies Matsuda restates Thornton's work, but it's a separate study.
- D) "Specifically" narrows from general to particular, but these are two independent studies.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Two concurrent scholarly efforts on related but distinct aspects = "meanwhile."

Q70. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Indeed,

REASONING: "The telescope's sensitivity is not accidental" (claim). The next sentence provides confirming evidence: the mirror was *engineered specifically* to collect faint light. "Indeed" confirms and substantiates the preceding assertion.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the design confirms the claim.
- B) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- C) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the mirror design is the substantiation of "not accidental," not merely an example.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Strong assertion → evidence confirming that assertion = "indeed."

Q71. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) In doing so,

REASONING: Khoury performed a specific action (coating walls with copper alloy, reducing infections). The blank sentence describes what that action demonstrated (a material intervention can supplement hand-hygiene protocols). "In doing so" connects the accomplished action to its demonstrated implication.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- C) "For instance" introduces an example, but the sentence draws a conclusion from the action, not illustrating something else.
- D) "Nevertheless" signals concession.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Described intervention → what the intervention demonstrated/proved = "in doing so."

Q72. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) By contrast,

REASONING: Pre-industrial: decentralized, hand-operated, home-based. Post-industrial: centralized factories, mechanized. The passage explicitly contrasts two historical periods of textile production.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Likewise" signals similarity, but factories were fundamentally different from home-based production.
- B) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the passage highlights a radical shift.
- D) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the factory system replaced the home system.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Before (old system) → after (fundamentally different system) = "by contrast."

Q73. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) Accordingly,

REASONING: The terns adjusted altitude based on wind conditions (strategy). They minimized energy expenditure (result of that strategy). The energy savings followed logically from the behavioral adjustment.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the energy savings are an expected outcome.
- C) "In comparison" requires two things being compared on the same metric.
- D) "For instance" introduces an example, but the energy savings are a result, not an illustration.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Behavioral strategy → outcome achieved through that strategy = "accordingly."

Q74. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Still,

REASONING: Said acknowledges that some critics see García Márquez's techniques as European modernist devices (opposing view). Despite this, she contends that his specific usage aligns more with oral narrative conventions (her maintained position). She holds her ground despite the counterargument.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the sentence reasserts her position against critics.
- B) "Similarly" signals agreement, but she's pushing back against critics.
- C) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the sentence is her counterargument.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "For example" is tempting because the sentence does provide specific details. But it's functioning as a counterargument to the critics' view, not as an example of it.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Acknowledges opposing view → reasserts original position = concession ("still," "nonetheless").

Q75. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) In reality,

REASONING: Popular accounts portray the Scientific Revolution as a swift rupture (common narrative). The truth: the transition was gradual and contested (correction of the narrative). "In reality" signals that the popular account is misleading.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the sentence corrects the narrative.
- C) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the sentence contradicts.
- D) "As a result" implies the gradual transition resulted from the popular narrative.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Popular accounts portray X. [blank] the truth is different." → "In reality."

Q76. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) For instance,

REASONING: Kovacs proposes a general theory (bright plumage = honest signal of fitness due to metabolic cost). The blank sentence gives a specific case (Wilson's bird of paradise) illustrating that theory.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "By contrast" signals opposition, but the specific bird supports the theory.
- B) "Nevertheless" signals concession.
- D) "Therefore" implies the bird's plumage is a consequence of the theory, which is backward—it's an illustration.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** General evolutionary theory → specific species illustrating that theory = "for instance."

Q77. [Hard] Correct Answer: B) Even so,

REASONING: Building codes were reformed after the earthquake (positive response). But the psychological/cultural scars couldn't be addressed by engineering (limitation of that response). Despite the structural improvements, deeper damage persisted.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the cultural scars contrast with the structural solutions—they represent what engineering *couldn't* fix.
- C) "Therefore" implies the cultural scars resulted from the building code changes.
- D) "For example" introduces an illustration, but the sentence isn't exemplifying code changes.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "In addition" is a strong trap because the cultural effects are additional consequences of the earthquake. But the phrase "no amount of structural engineering could address" explicitly signals a contrast with the engineering response described earlier.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Positive solution to one aspect → persistent problem in another aspect = concession ("even so").

Q78. [Hard] Correct Answer: D) Conversely,

REASONING: Standard models predict rational spending (theory). Udom found shoppers overpaid for "artisanal" labels without quality difference (behavior opposite to the rational prediction). The observed behavior is the reverse of what the model predicts.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Similarly" signals agreement, but overpaying without quality difference contradicts rational behavior.
- B) "In addition" adds compatible info, but the finding opposes the model.
- C) "As a result" implies irrational behavior results from the rational model.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Theoretical prediction → empirical finding showing opposite behavior = "conversely."

Q79. [Hard] Correct Answer: A) For instance,

REASONING: Dubois argues paintings were designed to interact with rock contours (general theory). The blank sentence gives a specific case (bison positioned on a limestone ridge) that illustrates this theory.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- B) "Nevertheless" signals concession, but the bison example supports the theory.
- C) "By contrast" signals opposition.
- D) "Similarly" signals a parallel from a different context, but this is the same context (Lascaux).

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** Theory about artist-rock interaction → specific example at Lascaux = "for instance."

Q80. [Hard] Correct Answer: C) On the contrary,

REASONING: The previous sentence says superconductors "might seem" incompatible with magnetism (apparent conclusion). The blank sentence reveals that the Meissner effect actually *enables* magnetic levitation (the opposite is true). What seems incompatible is actually the enabling mechanism.

WHY EACH OPTION IS WRONG:

- A) "Similarly" signals agreement, but the sentence reverses the apparent conclusion.
- B) "In addition" adds info, but the sentence directly contradicts the "seems incompatible" claim.
- D) "As a result" implies levitation results from incompatibility, which is misleading—it results from the Meissner effect specifically.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** "As a result" is the biggest trap. Students might think: Meissner effect expels magnetic fields → as a result, levitation happens. But the blank follows "might seem incompatible," so the transition must address the apparent paradox, not just describe a causal chain.

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** "Might seem to suggest X. [blank] the opposite is true." → "On the contrary."

TOPIC SUMMARY

Top 3 Mistakes Students Make

1. Confusing 'addition' with 'specification.' When a general claim is followed by a specific instance, students choose 'in addition' instead of 'specifically' or 'in particular.' Addition introduces a new, separate point; specification zooms in on the existing point.
2. Choosing 'similarly' when the relationship is actually contrast. Students focus on surface-level similarities (same topic) and miss that the data or behavior described is opposite. Always check whether the values, outcomes, or directions match.
3. Choosing 'for example' when the relationship is cause/effect. When a general mechanism is followed by an observable consequence, students see the consequence as an 'example.' Test: if the second sentence describes what happens because of the first, it's cause/effect, not illustration.

Top 3 Rules

1. Identify the logical relationship first, then match the transition. Before looking at options, determine whether sentences have a cause/effect, contrast, addition, specification, sequence, concession, or clarification relationship.
2. Read one sentence before AND one sentence after the blank. The relationship is between the context before the blank and the sentence the blank begins. Sometimes the sentence after also provides a clue.
3. Watch for 'setup' language. Phrases like 'many people assume,' 'it is tempting to think,' and 'might seem' signal contrast or correction. Phrases like 'numerous' or 'wide range' signal that specification follows.

Expected Frequency per Module

Transition questions typically appear 2–3 times per module on the Digital SAT Reading & Writing section (roughly 4–6 per full test across both modules). They are classified as Craft and Structure questions and can appear at any difficulty level. On harder modules, expect transitions embedded in longer, more complex passages where the logical relationship is less obvious.